THOMPSON RIVERS UNIVERSITY | Science

CLASSROOM VISITATION

Instructor: Dr. Sina Keshvadi Course: SENG4220 Date/Time: Feb24, 2025, 8:30 am-9:20 am
Evaluator: Dr. Zeinab Teimoori

INTRODUCTORY ACTIVITIES	
Instructional Skill	**Comments**
How does the instructor meet the class?	Dr. Sina arrived early and had the classroom fully prepared before the class started. He greeted students in a friendly and engaging manner, which was especially effective for a Monday morning class. The warm greeting helped set a positive tone for the session.
Outline/Objectives/overview for session given? Tie in with previous session?	The session began with a well-structured introduction to the topic. Dr. Sina provided a real-world example related to network security and internet connections to immediately engage students. The lecture was linked to the students' prior knowledge from their Networking course, helping them connect concepts from both subjects.
Instructor conscious of physical settings/ problems?	The instructor used multiple teaching tools effectively, including a pointer presenter, visual graphics, and the Computer Lab Management Tool, which allowed students to follow along on their own monitors instead of only using the projector. Moving around the classroom helped keep students engaged and attentive.
PRESENTATION	
Does there appear to be a plan for the class? Instructor well prepared?	The session was well-planned, with clear objectives and structured content. Slides were well-prepared and effectively designed for readability, using a purposeful color scheme (red, white, and black) to align with the security theme of the lecture.
Is the instructor organized and logical in the presentation?	The lecture followed a logical sequence, starting with a broad introduction to network security threats before narrowing down to specific attack methods. Each concept was introduced step by step, making it easy for students to follow. The lecture followed a logical order. Transitions between topics were smooth, and Dr. Sina paused to answer students' questions.
Are complex ideas explained clearly?	Complex security threats such as eavesdropping, sniffing, and network vulnerabilities were broken down into simple explanations. Dr. Sina demonstrated packet sniffing and explained how it is programmed. Physical and link-layer threats were described using relatable scenarios, such as watching YouTube.
Are key concepts/important point emphasized?	Each network security threat was reinforced with real-world examples. For instance, the topic of DHCP threats was explained using a Starbucks Wi-Fi scenario to illustrate how a new client connects to a new network. This approach made the concepts more memorable and applicable.
Speaking skills/eye contact/mannerisms.	The instructor used a clear and confident voice. His tone was varied to emphasize important points and maintain student attention. He also maintained eye contact and moved around the classroom to create an interactive learning environment. His pace was balanced that was neither too fast nor too slow. His moderate pitch and clear articulation enhanced the presentation's clarity and kept students engaged, ensuring the material was accessible and easy to follow.

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Variety of techniques/aids.	Dr. Sina used multiple teaching aids, including projector, pointer, graphics and visualizations, to demonstrate internet traffic and packet paths. The Computer Lab management Tool allowed students to see content directly on their monitors, enhancing engagement. The use of real-world security scenarios helped make abstract concepts more tangible.
Use of blackboard/whiteboard/projector.	As previously noted, the combination of tools used by Dr. Sina was effective. His dynamic teaching approach ensured students could visualize how security threats operate at different network layers.
Use of questions or feedback techniques.	Dr. Sina asked questions ranging from simple to challenging, encouraging student participation. He effectively encouraged the students to ask questions, and he actively responded to their inquiries. Questions were answered clearly, and feedback was provided throughout the session. He asked questions to check students' understanding. Throughout the lecture, Dr. Sina asked students thought-provoking questions, such as “What will happen if a man-in-the-middle uses a student’s account to send a packet from Moodle to Google?” These types of questions encouraged students to think critically about security threats.
Response to students’ questions.	Student inquiries were addressed clearly and effectively. Dr. Sina took time to explain concepts when students had doubts and provided additional real-world examples when necessary.
Pace of presentation.	The pace of the lecture given by Dr. Sina was manageable for students to follow. She maintained a steady and well-paced delivery to keep the audience engaged and ensure effective communication. The lecture moved at an effective pace. Dr. Sina ensured students could follow along by providing clear explanations and taking appropriate pauses to reinforce key points.
Use of examples.	Real-world examples were a core part of the lecture. For instance, blind spoofing and network scanning threats were explained through scenarios involving university instructors’ work habits and work-time patterns. TCP threats were illustrated with a discussion on SYN flood attacks.
Confidents/enthusiasm of Instructor	Dr. Sina demonstrated a strong command of the subject matter and showed enthusiasm for the topic. His passion for cybersecurity kept students engaged.
Participation – students active or passive? Attentive?	Students were actively engaged, responding to questions, taking notes, and participating in discussions. The interactive teaching style encouraged student involvement.
Control of class/general atmosphere.	Dr. Sina maintained effective control and created an engaging and attentive learning environment. Time management was effective with having the class started and ended on time. Dr. Sina managed the class well and created a focused learning environment.
Other comments.	Dr. Sina demonstrated excellent classroom management and engagement strategies. Students were actively involved throughout the session, showing attentiveness and participation.

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	Slides were well-prepared, and the variety of teaching techniques supported effective learning.
Suggestions for development.	Dr. Sina's lecture was well-structured, engaging, and informative. His use of real-world scenarios, visual aids, and interactive questioning kept students actively involved. The connection between Software Security and Networking helped students see the relevance of the material. Overall, this was a strong and effective lecture.
WRAP UP	
Instructional skill	**Comments**
Instructor's expectations/student responsibilities clear?	Dr. Sina clearly communicated the importance of security measures and usability, using a relatable example about locking doors when leaving the house. This reinforced the idea that increasing security often requires additional effort.
Session drawn together/summarized usefully?	Dr. Sina concluded the session by summarizing key threats and ensuring students understood how they connect to real-world cybersecurity challenges. The summary helped reinforce learning.
Time for questions?	Dr. Sina created an environment where students felt comfortable asking questions during the lecture. Time was allocated for student questions, and Dr. Sina provided clarifications on midterm-related concerns at the end of the lecture.
Transition to next session?	Before finishing, Dr. Sina briefly introduced the next session's topic, preparing students for upcoming discussions.

Guidelines for Classroom Visits by

Colleagues, Chairs, Associate Deans and Deans

1. The observer arranges with the Instructor to attend a class session appropriate for the observation of the Instructor's skills as a University teacher. Normally the class session will be 50 minutes in length.

2. The observer should plan to be in attendance before the class begins and remain until the class is over. For classes of two hours or more, the observer should arrange with the instructor to wrap up the first part of the class and take a short break after the first 50 minutes of class so the observer may leave.

3. It is recommended, but not mandatory for the observer and instructor to meet prior to the class. This meeting may be used by the instructor to explain his/her objectives for the class session to be observed. If the instructor plans to take an approach in the class that is experimental or unconventional the prior meeting provides an opportunity for the instructor to explain what s/he is attempting to achieve in the class.

4. It is recommended the instructor provide the observer with copies of instructional or other relevant material to orient the observer to the class.

5. The observer may use the reverse side of this sheet or another sheet to take accurate notes on the instructor's demonstrated teaching abilities in the class session.

6. If the observer doesn't have an opportunity to review his/her observations with the instructor after the class ends, a timely meeting for this purpose should be scheduled.

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7. Reminder: an important principle of effective classroom observation emphasizes the value of feedback not only on what you observe, but also on what the instructor might have done to improve the learning experience for students.

8. For observation in laboratories the observer should be in attendance for the laboratory introductory lecture (usually 10-15 minutes), and should remain for a further 10-15 minutes to observe the interaction of the lab demonstrator with the students.

Signed:_____Dr. Zeinab Teimoori_____